MEMBERSHIP AGREEMENT OF
SIGMA PHI EPSILON FRATERNITY, FLORIDA NU CHAPTER
Updated June 2026

The Alumni and Volunteer Corporation (AVC) and Executive Board of the chapter have approved the following Membership Agreement and intend to fully abide by and fully enforce its obligations.

I. Financial Obligations

A. Payments. Payment of all dues, fees, fines, assessments, and any and all other financial obligations shall be made by 11:59 PM EST on the date such obligations are due. Non-payment or late payment of any financial obligation shall be considered a violation of the Membership Agreement. You are responsible for paying any fees due by the deadline. The current VPF is listed under the Officers tab in the chapter's mySigEp.org profile.

B. The VPF and either his mentor or the AVC treasurer shall determine or confirm due dates for payment of financial obligations the semester prior to being due. The date shall be set for no later than the first meeting of each semester.

C. Amounts Due and Due Dates for 2026:
   1. Member dues are $750 per semester and are due upon invoicing.
   2. New member dues are $860. This includes the $310 SigEp Lifetime Membership Fee, which must be paid by the start of the first Sigma Challenge meeting to be admitted to the meeting and remain a member of the chapter.

D. Payment Plan. For those unable to pay the full amount of any financial obligations, you may apply to the VPF for a payment plan as determined and approved by the AVC. This option is available only if you have applied for the payment plan at least one week prior to the due date.

E. Late Payment or Nonpayment. Late payment or the failure to pay any portion of financial indebtedness when due shall be considered a violation of this Membership Agreement and, pursuant to Article II, Section 36 of the Bylaws, may result in one or more of the following penalties:
   1. Reprimand or censure
   2. Imposition of a fine of a maximum of $500 dollars
   3. Denial of specific privileges such as attendance at social events, voting, etc.
   4. After 7 days of non-payment, a late fee of $25 will be assessed and the member will be placed on social probation and not allowed to vote at chapter meetings.
   5. After 30 days of non-payment, the member will be placed on suspension and unable to attend any events. Another late fee of $25 will be assessed.
   6. After 60 days of non-payment, the member will be automatically expelled without a hearing as mandated by the Fraternity's Grand Chapter Bylaws.

F. Unacceptable Excuse—"Waiting for student loans or grants" shall not be an acceptable excuse for late payment of any financial obligation. Members are directed to pursue a payment plan or short-term loans from the university, their parents, or their bank while awaiting grants, loans, or scholarships.

II. Behavior and Conduct

A. Members are expected to have read and understood the local chapter and Grand Chapter bylaws, including, but not limited to, the provisions that impose consequences for violations of each.

B. Members are always expected to act according to the Cardinal Principles and Ritual of the Fraternity, whether at an official SigEp event or not.

C. Firearms. No firearms or any weapons, including pellet guns, BB guns, knives, and blades etc., may be present at any chapter function at any time or in the chapter facility. Possessing a weapon on campus is a crime. Violation of this policy subjects a member to immediate expulsion.

D. Drugs. No illegal drugs may be present at any chapter function or on any chapter property. Possession of such is grounds for immediate expulsion. This includes the use or sale of marijuana even in states where it has been decriminalized or the use of prescription drugs dispensed under someone else's prescription..

E. Alcohol. Alcohol is not allowed in any chapter or challenge meeting. Alcohol is prohibited in any chapter service, philanthropic, educational, or social event unless it fully complies with the Social Event Policy and Risk Management Policy. Members shall not attend any chapter event intoxicated.
   1. It is each member's responsibility to know the chapter's Social Event Policy and the Risk Management Policy. Two important rules are:
      a) All social events with alcohol must be strictly BYOB or provided by third-party vendors in accordance with applicable law, the Fraternity's and FIU's rules and regulations regarding the provision, possession, and consumption of alcohol.
         (1) The chapter shall not collect money officially or unofficially or directly or indirectly in any way to purchase alcohol.
      b) Guests at social events MUST be on a guest list kept at the entrance and monitored strictly.
      c) Each chapter member can invite a maximum of 3 guests to any event where alcohol is present.

F. Violent, Disorderly, or Illegal Behavior. Violent, disorderly, or illegal behavior by a member or member's guests will not be tolerated. Such conduct is grounds for immediate expulsion.
   1. It is a member's responsibility to know all applicable governing law and policies.

2. Members are always responsible for their guests.

G. Meetings, Events, and Functions
    1. SigEp meetings, brotherhood events, ritual ceremonies, and private functions shall only be attended by members and, on rare occasion, invited and approved guests.
    2. Chapter and Challenge meetings
        a) Roll calls will be taken at all meetings to account for participation and ensure only members are present.
        b) The conduct of chapter meetings shall be governed by Robert's Rules of Order or an equivalent method of maintaining decorum.
            (1) The chapter Guard or another member of the Standards Board will serve as Sergeant at Arms for chapter meetings.
            (2) The Sergeant at Arms will ensure order in the meeting, introduce any visitors, and ensure that the meeting is orderly.
        c) Members are expected to be **sober** at all chapter meetings and challenge meetings.
        d) Members are expected to respect the speaker or person who has the floor.
        e) Members are expected to stand when guests enter the room and to sit only when asked to do so. This includes alumni, sorority visits, guest speakers, etc. Members are expected to treat all guests respectfully before, during, and after their visit.
        f) Members who are disruptive or belligerent at chapter or challenge meetings will receive one warning from the Sergeant at Arms. If they continue with the behavior, they will be asked to leave the meeting, considered absent, and may be referred to the Standards Board for disciplinary action.
    3. Members who attend SigEp functions or events who are under the influence of drugs or intoxicated will be removed from the function and are subject to disciplinary action carried out by the Standards Board.
    4. All “Sound Body” events are prohibited unless they are held between 7 a.m. and 11 p.m.
        a) Sound Body, or similar chapter events, must be held on campus in an open, visible, and public venue unless expressly approved by the AVC and FIU.
            (1) Acceptable venues include the FIU gym, fields, and public athletic facilities.
            (2) The chapter facility is not considered an open, visible, and public venue for a Sound Body event unless expressly approved by the AVC.
        b) These events must be <u>strictly</u> optional for all members (for clarity, including new members). There shall be NO repercussions for anyone who does not attend any “Sound Body” event.

c) Provision or consumption of alcohol is strictly prohibited before, during, or within a reasonable time after any Sound Body event.

H. Adherence to SigEp's Risk Management Policies is essential to each member's obligation. Each member agrees to support and consistently follow SigEp's Risk Management Policies. Violation of these policies subjects a brother to fines, suspension, or expulsion pursuant to the local chapter or Grand Chapter Bylaws, as well as a potential loss of general liability insurance coverage.

I. No Agency. Under no circumstances will I be considered, or hold myself out, as an agent of Sigma Phi Epsilon Fraternity, nor will I represent to anyone that I am an agent for my chapter, unless I am specifically authorized to do so as an officer of my chapter or at the direction of my chapter.

J. Hazing

1. Hazing is a felony in Florida.
2. <u>No form</u> of hazing as defined by the Fraternity, the University or under the University's authority, or any other body whose authority is required for the chapter to exist or operate will be tolerated.
3. A new member cannot consent to any hazing activity under any circumstances. Conduct considered hazing is still considered hazing, notwithstanding a member's consent.
    a) There are no "voluntary" or "suggested" hazing activities. It is still considered hazing.
4. Any individual or group of members found to have been participating in any hazing activity will be subject to immediate suspension pending a hearing by the Standards Board, the University, and/or the Fraternity.
5. No alcohol may be present under any circumstances at any new member event or any event where the majority of participants are new members.
6. New members, regardless of age, are not allowed to provide, transport, or drink alcohol at any SigEp event or function.
7. No new member meetings, events, or functions may take place outside of the hours of 9 a.m. and 11 p.m. and must be held on campus or in an open, visible, and public venue.
8. New members will complete the Rite of Brotherhood no later than 30 days after they accept their bid to join the Fraternity.

K. <u>Belonging and Respect</u>

1. As a chapter dedicated to fostering inclusivity and respect, all members agree that acknowledging and honoring individual identities is paramount.

2. Members are prohibited from using racist language, derogatory remarks, hate speech, or discriminatory actions. This prohibition encompasses comments or behavior that degrade or insult individuals or groups based on race, ethnicity,

nationality, sexual orientation, or skin color.

L. Social Media
    1. No member will use any form of social media (including, but not limited to Facebook, X, Instagram, YouTube, Vimeo, Vine, etc.; print media, including flyers, banners, postcards, palm cards, and other handouts; email accounts, including Chapter listservs and Facebook groups or text messages) to distribute information, photos, or videos that contain language or images that are or may be considered illegal, against Fraternity or University policies, racist, sexist, homophobic, prejudiced, bigoted, lewd, or otherwise offensive.
    2. Violating this policy will result in revocation of certain privileges, fines up to $500, and suspension or expulsion at the discretion of the Standards Board and/or AVC.

III. Use of the Chapter Facility

A. The AVC leases the chapter facility from FIU. Therefore, the AVC has ultimate authority over all aspects of the facility, including rules, expectations, policies, and programming.
B. Undergraduate members are guests of the facility and are expected to abide by all rules, expectations, policies, and programming set by the AVC
C. Member use of the chapter facility is a privilege of membership, not a right.
D. All rules, regulations, and requirements in this document and the ByLaws of the local and national Fraternity apply to the use of the facility.
E. The facility shall at all times be a substance-free building.
    1. No illegal drugs (including marijuana in states that have legalized it or prescription drugs dispensed to other individuals) or tobacco (including vaping products) may be used at any time.
    2. No alcohol is allowed in the facility at any time for any purpose.
        a) Exceptions to this will be made up to six times a year for events hosted by the AVC that have been approved by the Center for Fraternity and Sorority Engagement and comply with FIU, SigEp, City, State, and Federal laws and policies.
    3. No use of tobacco products (including dip, chew, vape, cigars, cigarettes, etc.)
F. Chapter members and their guests are expected to treat the facility with the utmost respect and care at all times.
G. Chapter members and their guests are expected to treat the Graduate Advisor living in the facility with the utmost respect at all times.
H. Chapter members may not be in the facility outside of the designated opening and closing times set by the AVC and Graduate Advisor.
I. Access to the chapter facility can be revoked for violation of any Fraternity or FIU policy or as a result of any violation of any local, state, or federal law.
J. Any damage to the facility shall be paid for by the member(s) causing the damage.
    1. If a guest is the person who causes the damage, the member who invited the guest is responsible for the payment.

2. If no member takes responsibility, the damage will be paid for out of the chapter's funds.

IV. Membership Requirements

A. The requirements to **join** the chapter are:

1. 3.2 high school unweighted minimum GPA or 3.0 cumulative college GPA.
2. Must be a full-time undergraduate student at Florida International University (registered for a minimum of 9 credit hours during Fall or Spring Semester, or 3 credit hours in the Summer).
3. Must be registered with the Center of Fraternity and Sorority Engagement and sign all forms required via Panther Connect for FSL & IFC.
4. Must be registered on MySigEp & provide parental contact information.
5. Must complete & acknowledge Risk Management Policy Agreement on MySigEp
6. Must have read and signed this Membership Agreement.
7. Must have fulfilled all financial obligations.

B. The requirements to **remain** a chapter member are:

1. Must fulfill all financial obligations.
2. Must complete all BMP challenge requirements. Must fulfill all attendance requirements.
3. Must satisfy the following academic requirements:
    a) Maintain at least 6 credit hours at FIU for the fall and spring semesters.
    b) Achieve a GPA of at least 3.0 on a 4.0 scale each semester.
4. Failure to meet academic requirements.
    a) The membership of an undergraduate member with a term GPA below a 2.25 on a 4.0 scale for one term automatically, and without further action of the Standards Board, shall be placed on Level 2 membership-restricted status (as defined below).
        (1) If the member in question has a cumulative GPA of 3.0 or above, the member will instead be placed on Level 1 membership-restricted status, as defined below, for the duration of the next consecutive term of attendance in the Fall or Spring Semester.
    b) The membership of an undergraduate member with a term GPA between 2.26 and 2.99 on a 4.0 scale for one term automatically, and without further action of the Standards Board, shall be placed on Level 1 membership-restricted (as defined below) for the duration of the next consecutive term of attendance for the Fall or Spring Semester)
    c) If a member whose membership is restricted for academics (either Level 1 or 2) achieves less than a 3.0 GPA for the next consecutive term of attendance, the member shall be automatically expelled from the Fraternity with no right of appeal, but shall retain the right to be reinstated as provided in the Grand Chapter bylaws.

5. Executive Board officer academic requirements. A member must have a cumulative GPA of 3.0 or higher to run for an Executive Board position. Once elected, an officer must remain a member in good standing to remain in office.
6. Membership restriction for failure to meet academic requirements
    a) Members on Level 1 restricted status shall comply with the following:
        (1) Meet with the VPSLC to develop an academic support plan to improve his academic performance
        (2) Obtain an academic undergraduate mentor approved by the chapter's Standards Board and meet with his academic mentor regularly (minimum 1x a month) to review his progress
        (3) Attend a minimum of 2 hours per week of Study Halls at the chapter facility, or complete a minimum of eight hours of tutoring through Wyzant for the semester.
        (4) Failure to comply with the above expectations at any time during the semester will result in placing the member on Level 2 restricted status.
    b) Members on Level 2 restricted status shall have all the expectations of Level 1 status except they must schedule a meeting with the VPSLC & Faculty Fellow to develop an academic support plan within the first 4 weeks of the semester, must attend a minimum of 4 hours of study halls weekly, AND must complete a minimum of 4 hours of tutoring through Wyzant during the semester, AND will not be allowed to attend any social functions with alcohol for the semester included but not limited to tailgates, parties, mixers, formals, etc.
    c) Failure to comply with the above Level 2 expectations will result in the member's expulsion, without the right of appeal.
7. Summer Semester
    a) If a member on restricted status achieves a cumulative GPA above 3.0 through classes in the summer session, that member will be removed from restricted status.
    b) Since the university does not provide grade reports for summer semesters, the member must submit an official grade transcript to the Standards Board to have his restricted status removed.
8. Academic Incentives
        (1) Chapter members who achieve a 3.5 term GPA or higher while taking at least nine credit hours in the Fall or Spring semester will be awarded a $100 academic scholarship payable as a discount from that member's chapter dues for the following semester.
        (2) Chapter members who achieve a 4.0 GPA while taking at least nine credit hours in the Fall or Spring semester will be awarded a $350 academic scholarship payable as a discount from that member's chapter dues for the following semester.

(3) Chapter members who are First-Generation & Pell Grant students may be eligible for the FIU SigEp First Gen Scholarship, which is administered by the FIU Foundation.

C. Membership Rosters
    1. The chapter president shall maintain an accurate roster of members on MySigEp and FIU, and they must align.
    2. It is the responsibility of each chapter member to ensure that they are on both rosters or risk being removed from the chapter
    3. Only people who are on those official rosters may receive the benefits and rights of a chapter member.

V. Expectations for Member Development and Involvement

A. Balanced Man Program—All brothers of Sigma Phi Epsilon have joined an organization committed to the continued growth and development of every member. The following are the expectations of the Balanced Man Program.
    1. Each brother understands his personal responsibility to live up to and support the philosophical tenets of the Balanced Man Program, specifically:
        a) Equal rights and responsibilities
        b) Continuous Development
        c) Accountability
        d) Living the Ritual
        e) Mentoring

B. Each brother understands that there is **no place for hazing** new members or brothers within the Balanced Man Program. It is each brother's responsibility to ensure a safe, healthy, values-based experience in Sigma Phi Epsilon.

C. Each brother will fully participate in each of the Sigma, Phi, Epsilon, and Brother Mentor Challenges.

D. Each brother will be responsible for completing the required tasks and activities associated with the challenge in which he is currently participating, noted in the written challenge document, within the minimum and maximum time frames:

    1. Sigma Challenge: up to 8 weeks with Rite of Brotherhood after the 4th week
    2. Phi Challenge: 12 - 52 weeks (1-2 semesters)
    3. Epsilon Challenge: 28 - 80 weeks (2-4 semesters)
    4. Brother Mentor Challenge: Until Graduation (remaining college career)

E. Membership Lapsing
    1. Brothers who are unable to fulfill their commitment to the Balanced Man Program by completing each challenge within the maximum time frame, without extenuating circumstances, are subject to membership lapsing.

2. When a brother has reached the maximum time frame to complete a certain challenge, he must meet with the Standards Boards to decide whether an extension can be given or if he lapses and is expelled.

F. Expectations for Involvement and Attendance
    1. Recruitment
        a) Every brother is expected to participate in Formal and 365 Recruitment each semester.
        b) Members must communicate with potential new members in a respectful and courteous manner at all times.

    2. Chapter Meetings
        a) Chapter Meetings are mandatory. Brothers are expected to attend 75% of all chapter meetings each semester unless the Chaplain approves a valid excuse BEFORE the meeting takes place
        b) Chapter roll will be taken at every chapter meeting
        c) Chapter meetings are every Thursday evening.
        d) Failure to attend 75% of chapter meetings will result in a punishment determined by the Standards Board.
        e) Formal chapter meetings will be held once a month, and the appropriate Ritual attire must be worn. Otherwise, a member will be asked to leave and counted as absent.
    3. Rite of Brotherhood
        a) Members are expected to attend the Rite of Brotherhood unless they provide a valid excuse to the Chaplain 48 hours beforehand
    4. Chapter Retreat
        a) Members are expected to attend the annual chapter retreat in the Fall unless they provide a valid excuse to the executive board 7 days in advance. Failure to do so will result in a fine.
    5. Recruitment Events
        a) Members are expected to attend all formal recruitment events unless they provide a valid excuse to the executive board at least 7 days in advance. Failure to do so will result in a fine.
    6. Committees
        a) Every member and new member is expected to be on and participate in at least one chapter committee.
        b) A list of committees will be provided to all members at the beginning of each semester
    7. Other Events
        a) The chapter may set expectations for attendance and participation for other events such as philanthropies, service projects, intramurals, educational events, SLC events, etc., as long as those expectations are set at least 14 days ahead of time and voted on by a majority of the chapter.
    8. Reimbursement for Missed Paid Events:

a) Each member shall reimburse the chapter for any costs incurred on his behalf for paid events (etiquette dinner, tutoring sessions, retreats, formal, etc)
b) If the Alumni and Volunteer Corporation or the event sponsor has not previously specified these costs, they will be determined during a Standards Board hearing.

VI. Unofficial Membership, Social Membership, Inactive Status, and Early Alumni Status.

A. The Fraternity recognizes only three membership categories, each of which is defined in the Grand Chapter bylaws:
   1. Undergraduate member (which is an active status).
   2. Alumni member.
   3. Renaissance member.

B. The Fraternity **does not recognize any other membership status, including but not limited to** "unofficial," "social," "leave of absence," or "inactive."

C. Early alumni status is only available if a member (i) disaffiliates with FIU as a student for more than one academic year, or (ii) faces unique and extraordinary circumstances (including but not limited to military service, health, family, etc.) and, be granted to second-semester seniors with nine credits or less to graduate and must be approved by a majority vote of the chapter ***and*** the consent of the AVC president and Chapter Counselor.
   1. Members granted early alumni status may NOT participate in undergraduate chapter activities.

VII. ***See Something, Say Something.*** **IF I HAVE KNOWLEDGE THAT SOMEONE IS VIOLATING ANY PART OF THIS AGREEMENT, IT IS MY RESPONSIBILITY AS A MEMBER OF THE FRATERNITY TO IMMEDIATELY NOTIFY THE CHAPTER PRESIDENT, CHAPTER COUNSELOR, AND/OR AVC PRESIDENT.**

Membership Agreement Acknowledgement Form

I ACKNOWLEDGE THAT I HAVE READ AND FULLY UNDERSTAND THE ABOVE AGREEMENT AND ACCEPT THE TERMS. I UNDERSTAND THAT IS MY RESPONSIBILITY TO ADHERE TO THIS AGREEMENT.

_____

Member Name (Printed)

_____ _____

Member Name (Signature) **Date**